

PEEPING TOM

Michael Powell, 1960

Peeping Tom received a negative response on its release, but it is now considered a masterpiece. A photographer (Karlheinz Böhm) introduces himself to women as a documentary filmmaker, then murders them while using a movie camera to record the terror of their dying moments. The movie opens itself up to various psychoanalytic interpretations as it homes in on the phallic role of the camera. It also throws a chilling spotlight on the way movies turn audiences into voyeurs.

See also: *A Matter of Life and Death* 86–87

PSYCHO

Alfred Hitchcock, 1960

Psycho had an extraordinary effect on contemporary audiences. The shower scene, in which a woman (Janet Leigh) is stabbed repeatedly, is now one of the most famous in cinema. The movie set new standards for horror movies with its psychological complexity and the way Hitchcock ratcheted up the tension to fever pitch—helped by Bernard Herrmann's extraordinary jagged string score—as disturbed motel owner Norman Bates (Anthony Perkins) dresses up as his mother and turns murderous.

See also: *Vertigo* 140–45

WEST SIDE STORY

Robert Wise and Jerome Robbins, 1961

West Side Story takes William Shakespeare's *Romeo and Juliet* and turns it into a dynamic musical

played out between New York gangs, with the Sharks on one side and the Jets on the other. The movie is made exhilarating by Leonard Bernstein's sophisticated score, hugely memorable songs such as *Tonight* and *Somewhere*, with lyrics by Stephen Sondheim, and the spectacular dance sequences directed by Jerome Robbins. It won 10 Oscars, more than any other musical, including one for Rita Moreno, who made the song *America* her own, as Best Supporting Actress.

THE INNOCENTS

Jack Clayton, 1961

The Innocents is a chilling British supernatural thriller inspired by Henry James's 1898 novella *The Turn of the Screw*. Miss Giddens (Deborah Kerr) is employed as a governess to take care of a girl and a boy, and finds that they are haunted by the ghosts of their former governess and the alcoholic valet who seduced her. Director Jack Clayton brilliantly uses dissolves created by editor Jim Clark to suggest ghostly presences, and to bring tension and terror into everyday scenes such as lessons and bath time. The innocence of the children gradually transforms into something "secret, whispery, and indecent."

JULES ET JIM

François Truffaut, 1962

Truffaut's *Jules et Jim* was a classic of the French New Wave, shot in black and white, and packed with stylistic innovations such as freeze frames, wipes (frame transitions), and voice-over. The story is based on Henri-Pierre Roché's 1953

semiautobiographical novel, and focuses on the relationship between two friends—shy Austrian writer Jules and French bohemian Jim—and a free-spirited girl, Catherine (Jeanne Moreau), whom they both fall for. It celebrates friendship but ends in pain and betrayal.

See also: *The 400 Blows* 150–55

THE MANCHURIAN CANDIDATE

John Frankenheimer, 1962

Shot during the Cuban Missile Crisis, when paranoia about encroaching Soviet power was at its height, John Frankenheimer's Cold War conspiracy thriller captures the spirit of the times perfectly. It concerns an apparently heroic American officer, Shaw (Laurence Harvey), who was captured by the Soviets and brainwashed to commit murder when triggered to do so. Major Marco (Frank Sinatra) is the friend who discovers that the KGB "operators" controlling Shaw are actually his mother (Angela Lansbury) and stepfather. Dark, surprising, and inventively shot in a style that owes a debt to the French New Wave, it is a gripping, disturbing satire.

DRY SUMMER

Metin Erksan, 1963

Metin Erksan's powerful story of passion and greed upset critics in his home country when it was made, because of what they considered its negative portrayal of Turkish people, but it is now widely regarded as a masterpiece. The movie tells the story of a selfish tobacco farmer who builds a farm